

Same Object, Different AOK Classroom Run Kit

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • Cross-AOK • 30-40 min

Category	Cross-AOK	Time	30-40 min
Difficulty	Medium	ID	same-object-different-aok

Big idea: One object can carry many kinds of knowledge.

One-Minute Teacher Brief

Students prepare for exhibition-style thinking by analysing one object through many knowledge lenses.

Student Prompt

Inspect Same Object, Different AOK Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Same Object, Different AOK Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: A shell, coin, photograph, or medicine bottle examined by multiple AOKs. Name the AOK, the method being used, and the standard of evidence you would apply.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Same Object, Different AOK Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: A matrix with rows for AOK and columns for questions, methods, and evidence. Name the AOK, the method being used, and the standard of evidence you would apply.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Same Object, Different AOK Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: A debrief on whether the object changes or the knower's purpose changes. Name the AOK, the method being used, and the standard of evidence you would apply.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — One object can carry many kinds of knowledge.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
1	After inspecting Same Object, Different AOK Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: look for a clear claim, not just a description.
2	Which exact detail from Same Object, Different AOK Stimulus A did you use as evidence?	Teacher cue: students should name visible words, data, source features, method features, or contextual clues.
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?	Teacher cue: this is where assumptions, framing, models, or perspective usually appear.
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?	Teacher cue: confidence is data for the debrief, not a grade.
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: push for method, source, context, comparison, or definitions.
6	How does context change what an object helps us know?	Teacher cue: students should move from the classroom example to a general TOK issue.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to Cross-AOK.

Teacher Key / Reveal

The key move is not the “right answer”; it is the moment students see how one object can carry many kinds of knowledge.

- Strong response: separates observation from inference.
- Strong response: names a method, source, model, language choice, context, or perspective.
- Strong response: revises confidence when new evidence or a new criterion appears.
- Weak response: gives only opinion or says “it depends” without criteria.

Student Instructions

- Work silently for the first response so you can notice your own starting point.
- Record one knowledge claim, the evidence behind it, and your confidence level.
- After the reveal or comparison, update your claim in a different colour or column.
- Use the debrief to answer: How does context change what an object helps us know?

Setup Checklist

- Prepare a starter stimulus using: A shell, coin, photograph, or medicine bottle examined by multiple AOKs.
- Print or project the student response grid before the activity begins.
- Plan a private first-response moment before any group discussion.

Example Stimuli or Materials

- A shell, coin, photograph, or medicine bottle examined by multiple AOKs.
- A matrix with rows for AOK and columns for questions, methods, and evidence.
- A debrief on whether the object changes or the knower's purpose changes.

Resources To Use

- Resource pack: <resources/same-object-different-aok/index.html>
- Card deck CSV: <resources/same-object-different-aok/cards.csv>
- Visual prompt: <resources/same-object-different-aok/visual-prompt.svg>
- Printable student worksheet with observation, inference, evidence, and confidence columns.
- Teacher notes with setup checklist, sample facilitation language, misconceptions, and assessment look-fors.
- Classroom run kit with prompt cards, example stimuli, and debrief moves.
- PowerPoint deck with a student-facing sequence for running the activity.

Run Sequence

1. Place the object in the centre of the room or slide.
2. Groups rotate through AOK stations and add one insight at each station.
3. After the rotation, groups identify which AOK produced the most surprising knowledge.
4. Students formulate a TOK exhibition-style commentary.

Debrief Moves

- Knowledge question: How does context change what an object helps us know?
- Can one object belong to many knowledge communities?
- What makes an object suitable for the TOK exhibition?

Teacher Quick Script

- Write your first judgement before we discuss it; the first answer is useful evidence.
- Separate what you noticed from what you inferred.
- What would make this knowledge claim more reliable?

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...